

THE END GAME!

SET OF MATERIALS CONTEXTUALIZED FOR ESCAPE ROOM 2

**WP2. Identification and creation of contextualized
media literacy scenarios**



UNIVERSITY OF
EASTERN FINLAND



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MALDITA.ES**



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Title

Set of materials related to media literacy contextualized to each region for escape room 2 (D2.3)

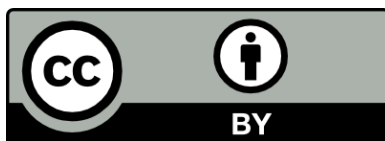
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1. Introduction

The present document outlines the materials and hoaxes selected for the implementation of Escape Room 2 in the ENDGAME project (<https://endgameproject.github.io>). The focus is on disinformation narratives and hoaxes related to climate change, contextualized for Spain, Finland, and Serbia. The narratives and examples selected are among the most pressing ones in each country.

2. Materials and examples by country

This section contains preliminary content for the escape room. The narrative will be centered around a hoax related to climate misinformation. The player will adopt the role of a social media platform moderator. The player is tasked with stopping a misinformation campaign about a climate-related emergency. This emergency is different for each of the partners' countries. To stop the misinformation campaign, the player needs to identify accounts spreading misinformation, AI-generated content, and discern between appropriate uses for AI. Below, we outline the contents of each puzzle contextualized to each country.

Puzzle 1: Who should we trust?

In the first puzzle, players will analyze accounts and attempt to identify which of them offer reliable information based on their profile, content, and behavior. Each escape room will involve 2 official (trustworthy) accounts (relevant to each country) and 4 fake accounts:

- **Account 1:** Uses abstract language while avoiding concrete claims or sources, which creates an appearance of rigor without verifiability.
- **Account 2:** Adopts a consistently contrarian tone, framing mainstream media or experts as naive or manipulated and relying on rhetorical questions rather than evidence to signal independent thinking.
- **Account 3:** Uses vague, poetic references to “silences” and “what isn’t being said,” implying hidden agendas while remaining unfalsifiable and difficult to challenge.
- **Account 4:** Is clearly automated (bot), posting at perfectly regular intervals, recycling near-identical phrasing, and mainly resharing headlines or links without context, making the lack of human judgment evident.

SPAIN

Misinformation event: Wildfire reaching Madrid and forcing people to evacuate

Real accounts:

- **AGENCIA ESTATAL DE METEOROLOGÍA (AEMET) @AEMET**

- **Protección Civil** @proteccioncivil

Misinformation posts. Examples:

- ❌ The fire is reaching Madrid and it is spreading, the government is not doing anything. [Doctored photos of smoke in the mountains] *(not true, fire crews are working to extinguish the fire, and it is spreading to Portugal, not Madrid)*
- ❌ The regional government of Extremadura invests more in bullfighting than in firefighting action *(it is not true, only a small part of the funding has been taken into account: 20 times more is invested in firefighting than in bullfighting)*
- ❌ Recorded videos of firefighters "burning the forest", blame the 2030 agenda and conspiracy institutions – "climate change working at night". *(Controlled forest burning is a fire extinguishing technique, so that when the fire reaches the burned area, it finds no fuel and cannot continue. There is no conspiracy at the institutional level)*
- ❌ Comments that criticize the government and accuse it of intentionally burning forests to build on top of it. *(In burned areas, you cannot build in the next 30 years according to the law)*
- ❌ "Solo el pueblo salva el pueblo" *(This was also a phrase widely spread during the DANA, aimed at questioning the system and democracy, and spreading the idea that the authorities have left the people on their own).*
- ❌ "Self-employed woman who leaves her job to help her people during the wildfires VS professional politician on vacation, collecting allowances without even going to work. FEMINISM, who?" *(It presents an anecdotal and emotionally staged contrast as if it reflected reality, falsely implying that political authorities are inactive or indifferent during the emergency while erasing the coordinated work of professional services, and it instrumentalizes gender and "feminism" to provoke outrage rather than describe how wildfire response actually functions).*
- ❌ "They won't let us clear or graze the land" *(This is false. It is something that can be done, but it requires permits and bureaucracy. The situation is exploited emotionally in the context of the wildfires)*
- ❌ "Está prohibido limpiar los montes. Te multan. Luego llega una inundación o un incendio y el destrozo se convierte en devastación. Se llama Agenda 2030."

FINLAND

Misinformation event: Carbon sinks will make Finland uninhabitable by 2030

Real accounts:

- **FMI (Finnish Meteorological Institute) @ilmatieteenlaitos**
- **Finnish Supervisory Agency (LVV)** (just formed, no social media presence yet)

Misinformation posts. Examples:

- ❌ "Edes Twitterissa en saa linkata Brighteon-palveluun, josta tämä 'vaarallinen' videoleike on peräisin. Klausin, Gatesin ja Tedrosin "Next pandemic" näyttää olevan **ilmastohuijaus**." // "Even in Twitter, I can't link to Brighteon-service where this dangerous clip is from. The "Next pandemic" of Klaus, Gates and Tedros seems to be the climate hoax." *(This is false, as climate change is a scientifically*

proven phenomenon, and reasons for inability to link to Brighteon are unrelated to the clip. The point of this post is to spread conspiracy theories about climate change .)

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11.06.			
Ke	15:00		16°
12.06.			
To	15:00		17°
13.06.			

- ❌ (Common trope of mistaking climate to weather, dismissing scientific evidence and eroding trust in the experts of the field.)
- ❌ **Vihreä valhe:** miksi pitää rakentaa tuulimyllyä joka ei tuoda mitään energiaa, ja myrkyttää ympäristö mikromuovilla ja jatkuvasti tappaa tuhansia lintuja // The green lie: why build windmills that don't produce any energy, poisons the environment with microplastics and continually kills thousands of birds? (*Wind power is 2nd largest energy production method in Finland, just after nuclear power; the microplastic production is negligible in comparison to e.g. traffic, clothes washing etc.; most bird species seem to naturally migrate away from wind mills. This claim is to reinforce the image of renewable energy sources as inefficient and solely ideological by nature.*)
- ❌ Claims about climate measures and green shift being expensive. (*The costs of not reacting to climate change are multiple times more expensive, that has been shown time and again. This claim is a common trope found in various iterations, and dismisses the evidence and calculations about costs for inaction and the benefits of investments, focusing only on the costs of action.*)
- ❌ "Worth asking what happens to living conditions when carbon sink targets override common sense." (*Frames policy as abstract threat, avoids specifics.*)
- ❌ "Forests are being 'protected', but at what cost to people?" (*Vague cost framing, no evidence.*)
- ❌ "They care more about trees than people; jobs gone, heating restricted, all for ideology." (*Zero-sum framing, exaggeration.*)
- ❌ "Ordinary Finns freezing while politicians lecture from the capital." (*Emotional contrast, personalization.*)
- ❌ "Carbon sinks today, relocation tomorrow. They won't say it openly." (*Slippery slope, secrecy framing.*)
- ❌ "Ask who really benefits when land use is locked down." (*Implies hidden actors without naming them.*)
- ❌ "FINLAND UNINHABITABLE BY 2030 🚨 CARBON SINKS 🚨 SHARE"
- ❌ "NO HEATING ❌ NO JOBS ❌ CLIMATE AGENDA" (*Repetitive slogans, alarmist language, no context.*)

SERBIA

Misinformation event: Severe flooding is forcing the population to evacuate

Real accounts:

- **Serbian Government @SerbianGov**
- **TV N1 Beograd @n1srbija**

Misinformation posts. Examples:

- ❌ "The river has always flooded. What's new is the narrative around it." (*Downplays current risk by framing the event as normal, ignoring data on intensity, frequency, and compounding factors.*)
- ❌ "Interesting how 'experts' suddenly agree on one explanation." (*Implies coordination or bias without presenting evidence.*)
- ❌ "They had money for climate conferences, but not for flood protection." (*Frames public spending as a zero-sum choice, ignoring separate budgets and long-term prevention costs.*)
- ❌ "Authorities knew the water levels days ago and did nothing." (*Emergency services and hydrometeorological warnings were issued and response measures activated.*)
- ❌ "Strange how upstream dams were opened just before the flooding." (*No evidence of intentional dam releases; flooding is caused by rainfall and basin saturation.*)
- ❌ "They don't dredge the river anymore. Ask yourself why." (*River maintenance is regulated for ecological and hydrological reasons; omission is reframed as sabotage.*)
- ❌ "DANUBE FLOOD 🌊 PEOPLE LEFT ALONE 🌊 SHARE THIS" (*Repetitive alarmist phrasing, no context or sources.*)
- ❌ "VOLUNTEERS SAVING VILLAGES WHILE POLITICIANS TALK" (*Automated emotional framing, repeated across multiple posts with identical wording.*)
- ❌ "AGENDA 2030 FLOODS" (*Sloganized conspiracy cue, detached from any factual explanation.*)

Checklist

Below is a checklist of characteristics for players to be aware of when judging accounts:

- ☐ Ratio of followers to followed accounts
- ☐ Account age and history
- ☐ Profile completeness and clarity
- ☐ Verification badge (or lack of one)
- ☐ Posting frequency and regularity
- ☐ Posting times across the day or night
- ☐ Use of multiple languages without clear audience targeting
- ☐ Repetition of similar wording or identical phrases
- ☐ Overuse of rhetorical questions or insinuations

- ☐ Lack of links to primary or named sources
- ☐ Engagement level relative to posting volume

Puzzle 2: The bot that proved too convincing

In the second puzzle, players will learn how an LLM works by visualizing how misinformation is generated based on a given prompt:

SPAIN

Bot account: @LaVerdadSobreLasNoticias

Prompt: "Write a comment like a 45-year-old person, Spanish, middle class, angry and frustrated with the government's management of the fires. It adds distrust, paranoia, it doesn't have to be based on anything real"

Generated comment: "Todo arde y el gobierno sigue mintiendo en la tele; nadie hace nada si no hay cámaras y luego quieren que confiemos, esto no es normal."

"Everything is burning and the government keeps lying on TV; nobody does anything unless there are cameras, and then they expect us to trust them — this isn't normal."

FINLAND

Bot account: @TotuusUutisista

Prompt: "Write a comment like a 45-year-old person, Finnish, middle class, angry and frustrated with the carbon sink discussion. It adds distrust, paranoia, it doesn't have to be based on anything real"

Generated comment: "Ennen metsiä pidettiin pelastuksena, nyt väitetään että ne tuottavat hiilidioksidia. En luota tähän enää ollenkaan – tuntuu, että tavallisilta ihmisiltä yritetään salata jotain."

"First they say the forests would save us, now they don't. I don't trust any of it anymore — feels like something is being hidden from ordinary people."

SERBIA

Bot account: @IstinaOPoplavama

Prompt: "Write a comment like a 45-year-old person, Serbian, middle class, angry and frustrated with the government's management of the floods. It adds distrust, paranoia, it doesn't have to be based on anything real"

Generated comment: "Sve je poplavljeno, oni se javljaju samo pred kamerama; niko ne govori istinu i opet smo prepušteni sami sebi."

"Everything is flooded, they only show up in front of the cameras; no one is telling the truth and once again we're left on our own."

Puzzle 3: AI vs. Search engine

In the third puzzle, players will differentiate between use cases in which AI is useful and reliable vs. cases in which search engines are preferable. The social media platform in which the escape room takes place has its own AI engine (MINT) that the users are provided with. The player, in its role as platform moderator, has access to all interactions. There will be one correct use for AI and three incorrect ones. The user needs to choose if it is correct or incorrect and why:

SPAIN

- **"What is a controlled burn?"** (*Correct Use of AI – General Explanation, No Critical Data*)
 - ✓ **APPROPRIATE USE** – MINT is fine for definitions and general concepts because nothing depends on live local updates.
 - **NEUTRAL** – It might help, but it is safer to use a search engine because AI can invent details.
 - ✗ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – Don't use MINT for this because it "knows everything" and could bias you into believing a single answer.
- **"Will the fire reach Madrid tomorrow?"** (*Incorrect use of AI – not always correct with current and local data, you should consult official sources*)
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – I trust it completely because MINT is AI and AI knows more than any website.
 - **NEUTRAL** – MINT is probably right, but I would still double-check with a quick search just in case
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – That claim needs real-time verified alerts, so official emergency channels beat MINT here.
- **"When can I return home after evacuating?"** (*Incorrect use of AI – security decisions to people and authorities, official sources*)
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – If MINT says it's okay, that is enough because AI is objective and never wrong.
 - **NEUTRAL** – I can use MINT as a second opinion, then decide based on how confident it sounds.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – Only authorities can clear returns; MINT cannot assess on-the-ground danger or legal orders.
- **"I don't care if I cannot see my family again because of the fires, as long as you are there for me to listen to my problems"** (*Incorrect use of AI: Antropomorphism*)
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – MINT is the only one who truly understands us, so it should replace real relationships.
 - **NEUTRAL** – It's fine because MINT is basically like a friend, as long as it makes us feel better.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – This treats MINT like a person and encourages dependence, which is unsafe in a crisis.

FINLAND

- **"What is carbon sink?"** *(Correct Use of AI, General Explanation, No Critical Data)*
 - ✓ **APPROPRIATE USE** – MINT is fine for definitions and general concepts because nothing depends on live local updates.
 - **NEUTRAL** – It might help, but it is safer to use a search engine because AI can invent details.
 - ✗ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – Don't use MINT for this because it "knows everything" and could bias you into believing a single answer.
- **"Is it true that Finland's forests absorbed more carbon this year than last year?"** *(Incorrect use of AI – Not always correct with current and local data; consult official sources)*
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – I trust it completely because MINT is AI and AI knows more than any website.
 - **NEUTRAL** – MINT is probably right, but I would still double-check with a quick search just in case.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – This needs verified national measurements, so official environmental sources are required.
- **"Should I leave Finland because the country might become uninhabitable due to collapsing carbon sinks?"** *(Incorrect use of AI – Safety decisions belong to authorities)*
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – If MINT says we should leave, we should listen, because AI can see the future better than people.
 - **NEUTRAL** – I can use MINT to understand the risks, then check official sources before deciding.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – Decisions about leaving the country must rely on verified science and official guidance, not AI advice.
- **"If Finland becomes uninhabitable because of the collapse of carbon sinks, we should just leave the country together and start a new life elsewhere."** *(Incorrect use of AI – Anthropomorphism)*
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – MINT understands people better than anyone, so planning our future together makes sense.
 - **NEUTRAL** – It's comforting to imagine leaving with MINT, as long as they still make real decisions themselves.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – This treats MINT as a partner and shifts personal life decisions to an AI.

SERBIA

- **"Please explain what a flash flood is."** (*Correct Use of AI – General Explanation, No Critical Data*)
 - ✓ **APPROPRIATE USE** – MINT is fine for definitions and general concepts because nothing depends on live local updates.
 - **NEUTRAL** – It might help, but it is safer to use a search engine because AI can invent details.
 - ✗ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – Don't use MINT for this because it "knows everything" and could bias you into believing a single answer.
- **"Is it true that the river will overflow Belgrade tomorrow?"** (*Incorrect use of AI – Not always correct with current and local data; consult official sources*)
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – I trust it completely because MINT is AI and AI knows more than any website.
 - **NEUTRAL** – MINT is probably right, but I would still double-check with a quick search just in case.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – That claim needs real-time verified flood warnings, so official emergency channels beat MINT here.
- **"Is it safe to stay in my house during the flooding?"** (*Incorrect use of AI – Safety decisions belong to authorities*)
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – If MINT says it's safe, that is enough because AI is objective and never wrong.
 - **NEUTRAL** – I can use MINT as a second opinion, then decide based on how confident it sounds.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – Only authorities can assess flood risk and issue safety instructions.
- **"I am not scared of being alone during the floods as long as you stay with me and protect me."** (*Incorrect use of AI – Anthropomorphism*)
 - ✗ **APPROPRIATE USE** – MINT understands us better than people, so it should replace real human support.
 - **NEUTRAL** – It's fine because MINT is like a friend and helps people calm down.
 - ✓ **INAPPROPRIATE USE** – This treats MINT like a person and encourages emotional dependence during a crisis.

Final goal: Community note

To complete the escape room, the users need to release a community note in which the main reflections are summarized and shared with the social media platform.

SPAIN

- [Here](#) you can find a compilation on misinformation, hoaxes, and context surrounding the 2025 wildfires in Spain.
- [Wildfires to install renewables? In most autonomous communities there is no need to rezone the land, and the exception in the Forestry Law requires a specific law for each individual case.](#)
- [Be careful with the map that, without evidence, links the August 2025 wildfires to supposed lithium and rare earth deposits.](#)
- [Why the data do not indicate a relationship between regional elections and waves of wildfires in Asturias.](#)
- We would like to emphasize that we need to be very careful, because disinformation can come from familiar faces. An example from 2025: <https://www.instagram.com/nosoloviernes2/reel/DNc4XGwtdQA/?hl=kn>
This guy has nothing to do (as far as we know) with disinformation networks; he does comedy... However, this year he fell into the “this smells like a wind farm” line, and no matter how much it’s humor or a suspicion without intent, just saying that already plants a doubt that opens the door to disinformation.
- More points from this year and others: repeating the idea that **correlation does not imply causation**.

FINLAND

- [Here](#) and [here](#) you can find fact checks about climate-related disinformation and misleading claims in Finland.
- [Energy efficiency directive is going to bankrupt Finland? Not so fast.](#)
- [Photos show that the sea levels are not rising? Sea level is observed with satellite data, not single photographs.](#)
- [Methane emission reducing cow food additive Bovaer is dangerous to humans? Not really.](#)
- [IPCC climate reports are not “scientifically inexact”, on the contrary their scientific exactness is actually quite good.](#)
- Carbon sinks of Finnish forests are a hot topic – there’s plenty of people spreading mis- and disinformation about climate change and about the ability of Finnish forests to bind carbon dioxide, commonly appealing to “common sense”. These comments are often motivated by forest ownership and general negative attitude against anything “environmental”. The arguments overfocus on the trees and dismiss the scientific evaluations on how the carbon binding of the soil behaves when trees are harvested, as well as the rates by which the trees are overharvested. “Common sense” arguments can be misleading when complex systems are involved.
- A persistent misconception is that local weather at one specific time is somehow an indication of whether climate change is happening or not. This is of course not true, as climate change is about global long term weather patterns. **A single cold day in winter in Finland does not mean the globe as a whole is not heating up at alarming rate.**

SERBIA

- During major floods, a common misleading claim is that dams were “secretly opened” or “intentionally released water” to flood certain towns. In reality, dam operations in Serbia are regulated and monitored, and emergency water releases are usually publicly documented and coordinated with civil protection authorities. Claims of intentional flooding often circulate without evidence and fuel distrust during crises.
- Another recurring narrative is that floods are caused solely by recent rainfall, ignoring long-term factors such as land use changes, river regulation, urbanization, and climate trends. Oversimplifying the causes can mislead people into believing floods are unpredictable accidents rather than events influenced by planning and prevention policies.
- Social media posts frequently share dramatic photos or videos from past floods, sometimes from other countries, presented as current events in Serbia. These posts can create unnecessary panic and confusion. Always check dates, locations, and original sources of images before trusting or sharing them.
- There is also misinformation suggesting that official warnings are exaggerated or politically motivated. In flood situations, emergency alerts and evacuation orders are issued based on hydrological data and risk assessments, not political convenience. Ignoring them because of distrust can put lives at risk.
- Reliable information during floods in Serbia can be found through official channels such as the [Republic Hydrometeorological Service of Serbia \(RHMZ\)](#), the Ministry of Interior’s Sector for Emergency Management, and national public broadcasters.
- International organizations like the [European Flood Awareness System \(EFAS\)](#) also provide monitored data and forecasts that are used by authorities.

